

friendly environment that continues to draw foreign investment. Building on this momentum, the Union Budget 2025-26 introduced a strategic framework to promote GCC expansion in Tier II cities. This includes building talent pipeline, developing world-class infrastructure and simplifying approvals through regulatory easing in key states.

India produces over 2.5 million STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics) graduates annually, creating a strong and continuous pipeline of engineers, IT specialists and AI professionals who are ready to meet the evolving business needs.

In addition to this, with over 5.8 million tech professionals, India hosts the world's second-largest IT talent pool. This workforce has deep expertise in software development, cybersecurity, AI and other emerging technologies, cementing India's position as a global leader in digital transformation.

48 | Several states—including Karnataka, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, and Madhya Pradesh—have introduced GCC-focused policies that offer incentives and infrastructure support to attract and scale up GCC operations, as per Talent 500. Dawber of Novo Nordisk GBS says India's supportive policy framework makes it a resilient and future-ready location.

Still, there is potential to do a lot more. "As a country, we must focus on streamlining entry pathways, enabling cost-effective GCC-as-a-service models, building vibrant innovation clusters and driving favourable policies," says Srinivasan. Randstad Digital's Shah says while India's improving ease of doing business and digital public infrastructure provide an edge, further reforms, including skilling and reskilling at scale by integrating advanced AI, quantum computing, cybersecurity and cloud-native curriculum to align with evolving GCC roles, can unlock greater value. "Another initiative could be boosting collaboration between universities and GCCs for research, innovation and co-development of curriculum. This will help prepare a future-ready work-



TIER II CITIES ARE GAINING STRATEGIC RELEVANCE

CBRE's Anshuman Magazine on how real estate cost advantage is driving the popularity of GCCs in emerging cities

BY RAHUL OBEROI

COMMERCIAL REAL ESTATE services firm CBRE believes the rise of global capability centres (GCC) in the country will increase demand for office spaces. In an exclusive interaction with Business Today, Anshuman Magazine, Chairman & CEO-India, South-East Asia, Middle East & Africa, CBRE, explains which cities are gaining traction in India beyond Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Pune and how the global leader in commercial real estate is prepping to meet the demand. Edited excerpts:



Which Indian cities do you see as emerging hotspots for GCCs beyond the established hubs?

Beyond the established GCC hubs of Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Pune, Delhi-NCR, Mumbai and Chennai are fast evolving as GCC hotspots in terms of expansion. Delhi-NCR is attracting more GCCs, supported by a diverse ecosystem and access to a broad talent pool. Mumbai continues to attract enterprises from the BFSI sector due to its financial prominence, whereas Chennai offers a compelling mix of IT expertise and industrial capabilities. Importantly, Tier II cities such as Coimbatore, Jaipur, Vizag, Kochi and Indore are emerging as viable alternatives within a hub-and-spoke model for GCCs. These regions offer a reasonable real estate cost